Ford Motor Company

September 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S27:** Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Fuel Line Inspection

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 model year Escape vehicles built at the Kansas City Assembly Plant from October 22, 1999 through September 1, 2000.

REASON FOR RECALL

In some of the affected vehicles the fuel line connector "o"-rings at the outlet end of the fuel filter may have been damaged during assembly, which can cause fuel odor or, in some cases, fuel leakage.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must perform a fuel line inspection. This inspection must be done on all of the affected vehicles. If there is wetness or fuel leakage at the fuel filter connector, the fuel supply line must be replaced.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

You must contact the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 to arrange for parts, if required. When calling this number, identify Safety Recall 00S27 and have the VIN of the vehicle to be serviced available.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV: Escape Special Handling Letter
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S27
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
Fuel Line Inspection

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid fuel line repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel, which will be at the customer's expense. Enter the word "LOANER" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area. See 'Escape Special Handling Procedure', Attachment IV.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S27
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
Fuel Line Inspection

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect Fuel Line for leak	00S27A	0.2 Hours
Install new Fuel Line (Includes Inspection)	00S27B	0.7 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Of the total population of approximately 12,000 vehicles subject to inspection, potentially 120 units (1%) are expected to require fuel line replacement. Dealers must call the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 when repairs are required.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S27
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
Fuel Line Inspection

Escape Special Handling

If Dealer <u>Picks up and Returns Vehicle</u> for Customer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
• Pick up the customer's vehicle (at a location of their preference such as home or place of business) and return after repair* • Drop off comparable loaner vehicle • Refill fuel tank • Wash and vacuum vehicle • Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed	Up to 2 hours additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum Note: Labor time to fill tank and wash/vacuum has been included in 2 hour allowance Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $62.36/hour and fuel cost of $1.50/gallon): 1.0 hrs. labor* = $62.36 9.0 gals fuel = 13.50 <u>Wash/vacuum = 10.00</u> Total Submitted = $85.86 *Travel time plus fueling/washing labor.
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up	Actual cost up to a maximum of $28 per day for a Ford rental. (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 2 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin

*Or repair on-site if appropriate; if on-site repair is performed, rental charges do not apply.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S27
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
Fuel Line Inspection

Escape Special Handling

If Customer Brings Vehicle to Dealer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
Refill fuel tank and wash/ vacuum vehicle	• Actual time, up to 0.5 hour, to fill tank, wash and vacuum • Actual cost of fuel, wash and vacuum • Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash+vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $62.36/hour and fuel cost of $1.50/gallon): 0.3 hrs. labor* = $ 18.71 9.0 gals fuel = $ 13.50 Wash/vacuum = $ 10.00 Total Submitted = $ 42.21 * Travel and labor time to fuel, wash and vacuum the vehicle when the vehicle is brought to dealer by the customer
Provide comparable rental vehicle to customer when vehicle is dropped off at the dealership	Actual cost up to a maximum of $28 per day for a Ford rental (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 2 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Perform repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified	See applicable information

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

September 2000

00S27

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2001 Escape vehicles.

What the safety issue is …	In some of the affected vehicles, the fuel line connector at the fuel filter may have damaged "o"-ring seals, which may allow a fuel odor or a small amount of fuel to drip onto the ground. You may notice the fuel odor, if this has occurred.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...	Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for inspection and if necessary, replacement of the fuel line.
What we are asking you to do …	Call your dealer without delay. Provide the dealer with your Vehicle Identification Number (located at the beginning of this letter). Ask for a service date for Safety Recall 00S27. When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.
If you've already paid for this service …	If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs